Corporate Travel & Expense Policy

Field	Value
Policy ID	POL-FIN-004
Version	3.2
Effective date	January 1, 2026
Owner	Global Finance - Travel & Expense Office
Applies to	All employees, contractors and interns of Contoso Ltd. and its subsidiaries
Currency	All amounts are in Canadian dollars (CAD) unless stated otherwise

1. Purpose

This policy defines which business expenses Contoso Ltd. will reimburse, the maximum amounts allowed, the documentation required, and the approval process. Its goal is to ensure employees are not out of pocket for legitimate business costs while maintaining cost control and compliance with tax regulations.

2. General Principles

2.1 Expenses must be reasonable, necessary, and incurred wholly for business purposes.

2.2 Employees should spend company money as carefully as they would their own, choosing the most economical option that meets the business need.

2.3 Personal expenses are never reimbursable, even when incurred during a business trip.

2.4 Where a limit is stated in this policy, it is a maximum, not an allowance. Only actual costs incurred are reimbursed.

3. Approval Thresholds

Expense report total (CAD)	Required approver
Up to $1,000	Direct manager
$1,000.01 - $5,000	Direct manager and department head
$5,000.01 - $15,000	Department head and Finance Business Partner
Above $15,000	Department head and CFO (or delegate)

Managers may not approve their own expenses or expenses of an employee who approves theirs.

4. Air and Rail Travel

4.1 All flights must be booked through the corporate travel portal at least 14 days in advance where possible.

Flight duration (one way)	Permitted class
Under 6 hours	Economy
6 to 9 hours	Premium economy

Flight duration (one way)	Permitted class
Over 9 hours	Business class (VP level and above, or with department head approval)

4.2 Rail travel is preferred over air for journeys under 4 hours door to door. Standard class is permitted; business class may be used on trips over 3 hours.

4.3 Baggage fees are reimbursable for one checked bag per flight. Seat selection fees up to $50 per flight are reimbursable.

5. Ground Transportation

5.1 Taxis and Ride-Share

Taxis and ride-share services (for example Uber or Lyft) may be used when public transit is impractical, unsafe, or would cost more in lost working time. Standard vehicle categories only; premium categories (Uber Black, Lyft Lux, limousines) are not reimbursable.

Taxi / ride-share scenario	Maximum reimbursable (CAD)
Single taxi or ride-share trip (local)	$75 per ride, including tip
Airport transfer (one way)	$120 per ride, including tip
Daily total for all taxi / ride-share trips	$200 per day
Late-night travel after 9:00 PM following approved overtime	Up to $100 per ride, home journey only
Tips	Up to 15% of the fare, included within the limits above

A receipt is required for every taxi or ride-share trip regardless of amount. The receipt must show date, pick-up and drop-off locations, and the amount paid. Amounts above the per-ride limit require written justification and manager approval; otherwise only the limit is reimbursed.

5.2 Rental Cars

Intermediate or smaller vehicles only, booked through the travel portal. Collision damage waiver is included in the corporate agreement and must not be purchased separately in Canada or the US. Fuel should be refilled before return.

5.3 Personal Vehicle Mileage

Use of a personal vehicle for business is reimbursed at $0.72 per km for the first 5,000 km in a calendar year and $0.66 per km thereafter. Commuting between home and the regular work location is not reimbursable. Parking up to $40 per day and highway tolls are reimbursable with receipts.

5.4 Public Transit

Public transit fares are fully reimbursable. Receipts are required for amounts over $25.

6. Accommodation

Hotels must be booked through the travel portal at preferred properties where available. Standard rooms only. Nightly room rate caps (before taxes) are:

City / region	Max nightly rate (CAD)
Toronto, Vancouver, Montreal	$300
Other Canadian cities	$220
New York, San Francisco, Boston	$400
Other US cities	$275
London, Zurich, Singapore, Tokyo	$425
All other international locations	$300

In-room movies, minibar, spa, and gym fees are not reimbursable. Laundry is reimbursable only for trips longer than 5 consecutive nights.

7. Meals and Per Diem

When travelling overnight, employees may claim actual meal costs up to the following daily limits, including tax and tip:

Meal	Canada / US (CAD)	International (CAD)
Breakfast	$25	$30
Lunch	$35	$40
Dinner	$65	$75
Daily maximum	$125	$145

Meals provided by a hotel, conference, or client may not be claimed. Alcohol is reimbursable only as part of approved client entertainment (Section 8). Meals during local, same-day travel are not reimbursable.

8. Client Entertainment

8.1 Client entertainment must have a clear business purpose and requires pre-approval from the department head when the expected cost exceeds $500.

8.2 The limit is $150 per attendee, including alcohol, tax, and tip. The expense report must list the names, titles, and organizations of all attendees and the business purpose.

8.3 Entertainment of government officials is subject to the Anti-Bribery Policy (POL-LEG-002) and always requires Legal pre-approval.

9. Other Reimbursable Expenses

Expense	Rule / limit (CAD)
Home internet (remote employees)	$60 per month
Mobile phone (non-corporate device)	$75 per month with manager approval
Professional memberships	$500 per year, must relate to current role

Expense	Rule / limit (CAD)
Training and certifications	Pre-approved via Learning portal; up to $2,500 per year
Home office equipment	One-time $750, every 3 years
Visa and passport fees	Reimbursable for business travel only

10. Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following are never reimbursed: traffic and parking fines; personal entertainment; travel for spouses or family members; premium ride-share categories; loyalty program fees; lost or stolen personal items; first-class airfare; gym memberships; personal grooming; costs incurred due to unapproved itinerary changes for personal reasons; and gifts to employees outside the Recognition Program.

11. Receipts and Documentation

11.1 Itemized receipts are required for every expense of $25 or more, and for every taxi, ride-share, hotel, and entertainment expense regardless of amount.

11.2 Credit card statements alone are not acceptable as receipts. Digital photos of receipts uploaded to the expense system are accepted; originals need not be retained.

11.3 A missing receipt declaration may be used at most 3 times per calendar year and for amounts under $75 each.

12. Submission Deadlines

12.1 Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days of the expense date (or the trip end date).

12.2 Reports submitted between 31 and 90 days late require department head approval. Expenses older than 90 days will not be reimbursed.

12.3 Approved reimbursements are paid by direct deposit within 10 business days of final approval.

13. Corporate Card

Employees who travel more than 4 times per year must hold a corporate card. The card is for business expenses only. Personal charges made by mistake must be repaid within 15 days. Card statements must be reconciled in the expense system within 30 days of the statement date.

14. Foreign Currency

Expenses incurred in foreign currency are converted to CAD at the rate on the corporate card statement or, for cash payments, the Bank of Canada daily rate on the transaction date. ATM withdrawal fees up to $10 per withdrawal are reimbursable.

15. Exceptions and Violations

15.1 Exceptions require written approval from the CFO or delegate before the expense is incurred, except in emergencies, where approval must be sought within 5 business days.

15.2 Misuse of company funds, falsified receipts, or repeated policy violations may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and recovery of amounts paid.

15.3 Questions about this policy should be directed to the Travel & Expense Office at expenses@contoso.com.

16. Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of changes
3.2	January 1, 2026	Taxi per-ride limit raised from $60 to $75; airport transfer limit added; mileage rate updated
3.1	April 1, 2025	Home office equipment allowance introduced
3.0	January 1, 2025	Hotel rate caps revised; rail-first rule for journeys under 4 hours